

HOUSE No. 4048

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Shirley B. Arriaga

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to reduce infection rate post surgery.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Shirley B. Arriaga</i>	<i>8th Hampden</i>	<i>1/10/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 4048

By Representative Arriaga of Chicopee, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 4048) of Shirley B. Arriaga relative to post surgery infection rates. Public Health.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to reduce infection rate post surgery.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 111 of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after section 231 the
2 following section:-

3 Section 231A. (a) For the purposes of this section, the term "surgical intensive care unit"
4 shall mean an intensive care unit, as defined in 105 CMR 130.020, within a hospital operated by
5 the commonwealth, that specializes in post-surgical care.

6 (b) Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, in all surgical intensive
7 care units, hospital staff and visitors shall wear medical or surgical masks when in rooms or
8 areas where a patient is present. The hospital shall post conspicuous signage to inform visitors of
9 this requirement.

10 (c) The health policy commission shall promulgate any regulations necessary to
11 implement this section.